Steven Wilssens

Product leader who invents new products, using data, experimentation and AI as tools

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LOOKING FOR
Product leadership roles building new products, where data, experimentation and AI are tools rather than the job · available now

SCOPE
Led teams of 10 to 20 product managers; telemetry from 1.6B+ Windows devices

BACKGROUND
Product leader since 2008, software engineer and team lead before that

SUMMARY

Product leader with nearly 20 years at Microsoft, inventing products in areas I was new to: spatial audio for Windows and Xbox, the low-latency approach behind xCloud game streaming, casting, and the data and experimentation systems that decide what ships on more than 1.6 billion Windows devices. Co-inventor on 19 granted US patents spanning spatial audio, game streaming, casting and device telemetry. I lead teams of 10 to 20 product managers, use data, experimentation and AI to find what works, and keep building products myself.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

250%+
growth in monthly active spatial-audio devices

1.6B+
Windows devices informing product decisions

+5%
Perfect Day improvement for Windows gaming

~30%
fewer issue days across Perfect Day scenarios

SKILLS

New product invention, from zero to one · Product strategy and roadmaps · Platform and game partnerships (Dolby, DTS, Netflix, Disney+, Halo, Forza Horizon, Gears of War, Call of Duty) · Data platforms, experimentation and A/B testing · AI and machine learning products · Hands-on AI product building (Claude Code, MCP, Cloudflare) · Leading PM organizations of 10 to 20, including managers of managers · Executive communication · Software engineering background (C#, .NET)

EXPERIENCE

Oct 2026 - Present

Independent AI Product Builder

Independent · Seattle, Washington

Building AI products independently after Microsoft.

- Building AI Breaker, a Windows app that lets people turn off AI features in graduated levels.
- Built a multi-tenant hosting and email platform with MCP-based AI apps in 16 days (wilssens.com): isolated server code and database per site, automated mailbox provisioning, and every action available on the web, over MCP and from a command line.
- Runs juniortrackcycling.com, a content and analytics site for the junior track cycling community.

Dec 2024 - Sep 2026

Principal Group Product Manager - Windows & Devices Data

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Led product management for the entire Windows & Devices Data organization: the data, insights, experimentation, and machine learning models that power decision-making across Windows and Devices.

- Led a PM organization of about 20, working with more than 100 developers and data scientists, initially through three people managers, then led its move to a flatter team of about 12 during Microsoft's cost reductions; roughly half the team was promoted under my leadership.
- Owned strategy and roadmap for the data platform and insights products Windows engineers and PMs use to ship higher-quality releases.
- Built the quality measurement framework that underpinned Windows K2, Microsoft's high-profile push to improve Windows reliability and performance.
- Ran the weekly ship-readiness quality review where Windows VPs made release decisions based on my team's data on ship-blocking issues.
- Scaled experimentation adoption across Windows, significantly reducing the number of features pulled back after release.

- Owned the multi-million-dollar Windows data infrastructure budget; shut down a low-adoption on-device model platform and reinvested in platform modernization, cutting costs 30% over two years.
- Shifted the team to AI-driven analytics and launched the first version, letting people ask business questions in natural language across every source in the data platform instead of relying on fixed queries.
- Partnered with engineering, data science, and research leadership across telemetry from more than 1.6 billion Windows devices.

Feb 2020 - Dec 2024

Principal Product Manager Lead - Windows Data

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Built data products that told the story of the Windows customer experience and informed continuous improvement.

- Redefined Windows quality measurement around end-to-end scenarios like gaming and the shell, creating the Perfect Day metric for issue-free user days.

Sep 2019 - Feb 2020

Principal Product Manager Lead - Azure DevOps

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Defined new products, go-to-market strategies, and business decisions for the Azure DevOps Platform.

- Authored a DataOps product proposal compelling enough that the team building it was moved to GitHub, as the better home for the product.

Jan 2018 - Sep 2019

Principal Product Manager Lead - Silicon, Graphics, Media

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Led audio, spatial audio, game streaming, xCloud, Game DVR, broadcast, and casting initiatives.

- Led six PMs, working with about 20 developers.

Sep 2017 - Jan 2018

Principal Product Manager - Silicon, Graphics, Media

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Drove the Windows Sonic spatial audio platform for Windows and Xbox One while representing Microsoft at developer and game conferences.

- Drove the launch of Dolby Access v3 and DTS Sound Unbound with new app services, licensing, and customization models.

Oct 2008 - Aug 2017

Senior Product Manager - Silicon, Graphics, Media

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Led media platform work across casting, conferencing and spatial audio, culminating in the Spatial Audio Platform and Windows Sonic for Windows and Xbox One.

- Brought casting to Windows and Windows Phone, shipping Miracast, DLNA and Play To so people could send media from a PC or phone to a TV.

Oct 2006 - Sep 2008

Product Manager - Developer Division

Microsoft · Redmond, Washington

Product manager in Microsoft's Developer Division working on developer ecosystem and community products.

- Launched the Visual Studio Marketplace, giving developers one place to find and share Visual Studio extensions.

EARLIER CAREER · BELGIUM

Jan 2006 - Sep 2006 — **Lead Developer and Team Lead**, Compuware · Belgium
Led a team of about 15 developers and the Project Support Office for Fluxys.

Jan 2005 - Dec 2005 — **Software Developer**, Cosmos · Antwerp Area, Belgium
Built and supported software components across C# client and Java server systems using CORBA middleware.

Jan 2001 - Dec 2004 — **Developer and Trainer**, Info Support · Belgium
Developed distributed .NET applications and trained teams across multiple organizations.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's degree, Computer Science
Karel de Grote, Belgium · 2000 - 2004

Languages
Dutch and English (native), French (intermediate)

HONORS

Lighthouse Award for Teamwork (2012) · Compass Award for Individual Excellence (2011) · Gold Star Award (2011) · Microsoft MVP: VS Team System (2006)

PATENTS AND PRESS

19 granted US patents, 7 published applications
Spatial audio, streaming, media and device telemetry (Microsoft). Press: Forbes, Windows Central; Build 2016 speaker.
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